

GEOGRAPHICAL SETTING & ECOLOGY

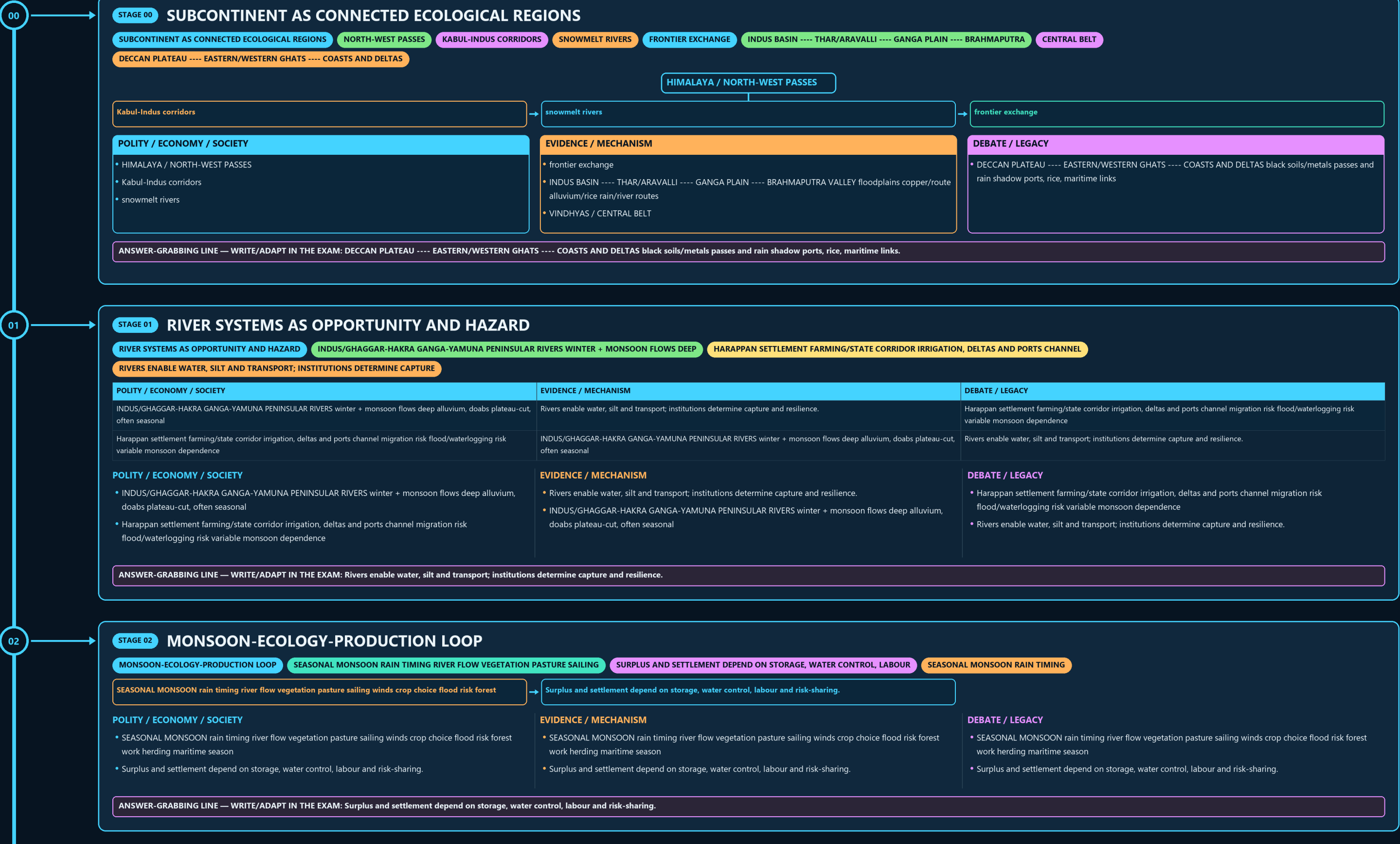
SUBCONTINENT AS CONNECTED ECOLOGICAL → RIVER SYSTEMS AS OPPORTUNITY → MONSOON-ECOLOGY-PRODUCTION LOOP → RESOURCE GEOGRAPHY AND SPECIALISED → WHY SETTLEMENTS OCCUPY PARTICULAR → ROUTES: MOVEMENT CREATES HISTORICAL

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g15 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

SEASONAL MONSOON rain timing river flow vegetation pasture sailing winds crop choice flood risk forest

→

Surplus and settlement depend on storage, water control, labour and risk-sharing.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SEASONAL MONSOON rain timing river flow vegetation pasture sailing winds crop choice flood risk forest work herding maritime season
- Surplus and settlement depend on storage, water control, labour and risk-sharing.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- SEASONAL MONSOON rain timing river flow vegetation pasture sailing winds crop choice flood risk forest work herding maritime season
- Surplus and settlement depend on storage, water control, labour and risk-sharing.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SEASONAL MONSOON rain timing river flow vegetation pasture sailing winds crop choice flood risk forest work herding maritime season
- Surplus and settlement depend on storage, water control, labour and risk-sharing.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Surplus and settlement depend on storage, water control, labour and risk-sharing.

03

STAGE 03

RESOURCE GEOGRAPHY AND SPECIALISED REGIONS

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REPRESENTATIVE ZONES

HISTORICAL CAPACITY COPPER

TOOLS, EXCHANGE, CRAFT CENTRES IRON

CENTRAL/EASTERN INDIA

TOOLS AND WEAPONS; USE REMAINS CONTEXTUAL STONE

LITHICS, ARCHITECTURE AND SCULPTURE TIMBER

FOREST BELTS

RESOURCE — REPRESENTATIVE ZONES — HISTORICAL CAPACITY copper — Aravalli/Khetri — tools, exchange, craft centres

use remains contextual stone — Rohri/Deccan/Vindhya — lithics, architecture and sculpture timber — forest belts

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- RESOURCE — REPRESENTATIVE ZONES — HISTORICAL CAPACITY copper — Aravalli/Khetri — tools, exchange, craft centres iron — central/eastern
- use remains contextual stone — Rohri/Deccan/Vindhya — lithics, architecture and sculpture timber — forest belts — fuel, construction,

METHOD / DEBATE

- RESOURCE — REPRESENTATIVE ZONES — HISTORICAL CAPACITY copper — Aravalli/Khetri — tools, exchange, craft centres iron — central/eastern
- use remains contextual stone — Rohri/Deccan/Vindhya — lithics, architecture and sculpture timber — forest belts — fuel, construction,

HISTORICAL RESULT

- RESOURCE — REPRESENTATIVE ZONES — HISTORICAL CAPACITY copper — Aravalli/Khetri — tools, exchange, craft centres iron — central/eastern
- use remains contextual stone — Rohri/Deccan/Vindhya — lithics, architecture and sculpture timber — forest belts — fuel, construction,

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESOURCE — REPRESENTATIVE ZONES — HISTORICAL CAPACITY copper — Aravalli/Khetri — tools, exchange, craft centres iron — central/eastern India — tools and weapons; use remains contextual stone — Rohri/Deccan/Vindhya — lithics, architecture and sculpture timber — forest belts — fuel, construction, boats, state frontier salt — arid/coastal sources — essential exchange networks elephant — eastern forests — military resource, not sole cause of empire.

04

STAGE 04

WHY SETTLEMENTS OCCUPY PARTICULAR LANDSCAPES

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SITE SELECTION WATER RELIABILITY CULTIVABLE SOIL AND GRAZING DEFENSIBILITY

SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY

CRAFT CENTRE

GEOGRAPHY SETS COSTS AND OPTIONS; SOCIAL ORGANISATION CONVERTS THEM

SITE SELECTION water reliability cultivable soil and grazing defensibility and flood safety

→

raw-material access route, ford or port position disease and drainage constraints

→

SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY: camp — village — craft centre — town — capital

→

Geography sets costs and options; social organisation converts them into settlement.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- SITE SELECTION water reliability cultivable soil and grazing defensibility and flood safety
- raw-material access route, ford or port position disease and drainage constraints

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY: camp — village — craft centre — town — capital
- Geography sets costs and options; social organisation converts them into settlement.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SITE SELECTION water reliability cultivable soil and grazing defensibility and flood safety
- raw-material access route, ford or port position disease and drainage constraints

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Geography sets costs and options; social organisation converts them into settlement.

05

STAGE 05

ROUTES: MOVEMENT CREATES HISTORICAL CORRIDORS

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LAND AND WATER ROUTES PASSES RIVERWAYS PLATEAU GAPS COASTS/MONSOON

GOODS, PEOPLE, SCRIPTS, CULTS AND TECHNOLOGIES MOVE; ROUTES DO

LAND AND WATER ROUTES

LAND AND WATER ROUTES passes riverways plateau gaps coasts/monsoon sea migration bulk goods Deccan links

Goods, people, scripts, cults and technologies move; routes do not erase local agency.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LAND AND WATER ROUTES passes riverways plateau gaps coasts/monsoon sea migration bulk goods Deccan links ports and overseas exchange
- Goods, people, scripts, cults and technologies move; routes do not erase local agency.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- LAND AND WATER ROUTES passes riverways plateau gaps coasts/monsoon sea migration bulk goods Deccan links ports and overseas exchange
- Goods, people, scripts, cults and technologies move; routes do not erase local agency.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- LAND AND WATER ROUTES passes riverways plateau gaps coasts/monsoon sea migration bulk goods Deccan links ports and overseas exchange
- Goods, people, scripts, cults and technologies move; routes do not erase local agency.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Goods, people, scripts, cults and technologies move; routes do not erase local agency.

06

STAGE 06

CHANGING HISTORICAL LANDSCAPES

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EARLY HISTORIC MOBILE USE VILLAGE MOSAICS URBAN-RURAL NW TO

NO ALL-INDIA STAGE OCCURS SIMULTANEOUSLY

REGIONAL SEQUENCES OVERLAP AND DIVERGE.

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06

Deccan links ports and overseas exchange

• Goods, people, scripts, cults and technologies move; routes do not erase local agency.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Goods, people, scripts, cults and technologies move; routes do not erase local agency.

06

STAGE 06

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REGIONAL SEQUENCES OVERLAP AND DIVERGE.

PALAEOLITHIC → NEOLITHIC/CHALCOLITHIC → HARAPPAN → VEDIC → EARLY HISTORIC mobile use village

→ mosaics urban-rural NW to Ganga towns/states/routes stone/water crops/herds basin links forest edge Magadha/Deccan/coasts

→ No all-India stage occurs simultaneously: regional sequences overlap and diverge.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

• PALAEOLITHIC → NEOLITHIC/CHALCOLITHIC → HARAPPAN → VEDIC → EARLY HISTORIC mobile use village

• mosaics urban-rural NW to Ganga towns/states/routes stone/water crops/herds basin links forest edge Magadha/Deccan/coasts

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

• No all-India stage occurs simultaneously: regional sequences overlap and diverge.

• PALAEOLITHIC → NEOLITHIC/CHALCOLITHIC → HARAPPAN → VEDIC → EARLY HISTORIC mobile use village

IMPACT / LIMIT

• mosaics urban-rural NW to Ganga towns/states/routes stone/water crops/herds basin links forest edge Magadha/Deccan/coasts

• No all-India stage occurs simultaneously: regional sequences overlap and diverge.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: No all-India stage occurs simultaneously: regional sequences overlap and diverge.

07

STAGE 07

DETERMINISM VERSUS POSSIBILISM

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DETERMINIST CLAIM

FERTILE SOIL, IRON, RIVER OR MONSOON AUTOMATICALLY PRODUCES A

EVIDENCE AGAINST

SIMILAR ENVIRONMENTS YIELD DIFFERENT TIMINGS AND INSTITUTIONS.

POSSIBILIST CORRECTION

ECOLOGY OFFERS CONSTRAINTS, OPPORTUNITIES AND RECURRING RISKS.

TECHNOLOGY + LABOUR + PROPERTY + EXCHANGE + POLITICAL

SOURCE / MATERIAL

• DETERMINIST CLAIM: fertile soil, iron, river or monsoon automatically produces a state.

• EVIDENCE AGAINST: similar environments yield different timings and institutions.

METHOD / DEBATE

• POSSIBILIST CORRECTION: ecology offers constraints, opportunities and recurring risks.

• MEDIATORS: technology + labour + property + exchange + political organisation + culture

HISTORICAL RESULT

• VERDICT: explain why an opportunity was mobilised, by whom, and with what limits.

• DETERMINIST CLAIM: fertile soil, iron, river or monsoon automatically produces a state.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: explain why an opportunity was mobilised, by whom, and with what limits.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: explain why an opportunity was mobilised, by whom, and with what limits.

08

STAGE 08

HISTORICAL-GEOGRAPHY ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

HISTORICAL-GEOGRAPHY ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS

LOCATE REGION

NAME RESOURCE/ECOLOGY

NAMED CASE

15 MARKS

TEXT MAP

OPPORTUNITIES + CONSTRAINTS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

• 10 MARKS: locate region → name resource/ecology → mechanism → named case

• 15 MARKS: text map → opportunities + constraints → institutional mediators → variation

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

• 20 MARKS: physical frame → river/monsoon/resource systems → chronological cases

• routes and uneven regions → determinism debate → qualified synthesis

DEBATE / LEGACY

• MAP RULE: label only places used in the argument; link each label to one consequence.

• CLOSE: geography conditions history, but institutions select and transform options.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — MAP RULE: label only places used in the argument; link each label to one consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: label only places used in the argument; link each label to one consequence.

09

STAGE 09

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

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EVIDENCE LADDER

1. CONVERT RELIEF, WATER, CLIMATE AND RESOURCES INTO A

2. ADD TECHNOLOGY, LABOUR, INSTITUTIONS AND POWER BEFORE CLAIMING

3. STATE EACH PROXY'S CATCHMENT, CHRONOLOGY, PRESERVATION AND ALTERNATIVE

GEOGRAPHY CONDITIONS CHOICES; IT DOES NOT DICTATE ONE INEVITABLE

SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. Add technology, labour, institutions and power before claiming an outcome.	VERDICT: Geography conditions choices; it does not dictate one inevitable history.
1. Convert relief, water, climate and resources into a dated historical mechanism.	3. State each proxy's catchment, chronology, preservation and alternative causes.	EVIDENCE LADDER

SOURCE / MATERIAL

• EVIDENCE LADDER

• 1. Convert relief, water, climate and resources into a dated historical mechanism.

METHOD / DEBATE

• 2. Add technology, labour, institutions and power before claiming an outcome.

• 3. State each proxy's catchment, chronology, preservation and alternative causes.

HISTORICAL RESULT

• VERDICT: Geography conditions choices; it does not dictate one inevitable history.

• EVIDENCE LADDER

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SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. Add technology, labour, institutions and power before claiming an outcome.	VERDICT: Geography conditions choices; it does not dictate one inevitable history.
1. Convert relief, water, climate and resources into a dated historical mechanism.	3. State each proxy's catchment, chronology, preservation and alternative causes.	EVIDENCE LADDER
SOURCE / MATERIAL - EVIDENCE LADDER 1. Convert relief, water, climate and resources into a dated historical mechanism.	METHOD / DEBATE 2. Add technology, labour, institutions and power before claiming an outcome. 3. State each proxy's catchment, chronology, preservation and alternative causes.	HISTORICAL RESULT - VERDICT: Geography conditions choices; it does not dictate one inevitable history. - EVIDENCE LADDER

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Geography conditions choices; it does not dictate one inevitable history.

STAGE 10 EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

3. RESOURCE MAPS ARE NOT POLITICAL MAPS; MODERN BORDERS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CLOSE DISTINCTIONS	2. A palaeochannel is not a named textual river; correlation is not causation.	VERDICT: Date the landscape, match the scale and preserve regional variation.
1. Mountains are barriers and corridors; rivers are routes and changing hazards.	3. Resource maps are not political maps; modern borders are not ancient regions.	CLOSE DISTINCTIONS
POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
• CLOSE DISTINCTIONS	• 2. A palaeochannel is not a named textual river; correlation is not causation.	• VERDICT: Date the landscape, match the scale and preserve regional variation.
• 1. Mountains are barriers and corridors; rivers are routes and changing hazards.	• 3. Resource maps are not political maps; modern borders are not ancient regions.	• CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Date the landscape, match the scale and preserve regional variation.

STAGE 11 INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

3. COMPARE PREHISTORIC, HARAPPAN, VEDIC AND EARLY HISTORIC USES

- VERDICT: Societies selected, connected and transformed geographic possibilities.
- ANSWER SPINE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT: Societies selected, connected and transformed geographic possibilities.

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.